

EXOPLANETS

Planets outside our Solar System are called exoplanets. To date, astronomers have found more than 3,000 exoplanets orbiting other stars beyond our Solar System. So far, these other planets are mainly much bigger or much hotter than our Earth. But the search is on for a planet similar to Earth – a warm, wet world, that may be home to some form of alien life.

Astronomers think there are **40 billion Earth-like planets** in the Milky Way.

HD 189733 A

The star's planet, HD 189733 b, is similar in size to Jupiter, but is roasted by its proximity to its parent star

THE SEARCH FOR ALIEN LIFE

The dishes of the Allen Telescope Array in California, USA, form a highly sensitive "ear" on the Universe, listening out for a radio broadcast from any intelligent aliens that may live on distant planets. The Array is part of an international project called SETI (Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence).

